

Prahlín Portfolio Work Log - September 21, 2026

Compiled summary for Monday, September 21, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio work after the September 16 Part 1 documentation state, verifying the United States Eastern date, refreshing the project snapshot, extracting and studying all thirty-nine pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs, refining the About Dev hero narrative and quote composition, transforming the How I Got Here timeline into a practical My Work Methodology sequence, rewriting the research, planning, workflow, and learning copy, adding selective inline emphasis and true multi-paragraph timeline support, correcting About Dev hero typography and navbar-to-content spacing across desktop and mobile, preserving the page-specific profile nametag, clearing and rebuilding the local Next.js development cache, validating TypeScript and static production output, restoring the Next.js dev route reference after the build, documenting committed source state 64cb140, and generating the September 21 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlín Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahlín/portfolio work performed after `portfolio_worklog_september16_part1.pdf` and after the September 16 Part 1 documentation state. The source state reviewed for this record is 64cb140e446673cf7904ca52c77a763d99b12bf0 on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated, titled Refined the About Dev narrative and methodology. The September 21 source work in scope is represented by that commit. No Hostinger deploy-branch work, production publish, or public deployment was performed during this documentation pass. The only tracked delta before PDF generation was the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` file; this PDF is the new September 21 root-level documentation artifact requested by the user.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date with TZ=America/New_York date from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio. It reported Monday, September 21, 2026 at 10:42 PM EDT with UTC offset -0400; a second verification at 10:44 PM EDT confirmed the same date and offset. The worklog therefore uses September 21, 2026 even though systems operating in UTC were already on September 22.
- Ran `./read_project.sh` from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before writing this worklog, preserving the Portfolio convention that the current source snapshot is refreshed before session documentation.
- Reviewed the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` for the current source tree, route and component structure, public image inventory, PDF worklog inventory, package scripts, deployment configuration, git context, generated-cache policy, and standing workflow notes.
- Extracted and studied all thirty-nine pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with `pdftotext`: the July 11, 14, 15 Part 1, 15 Part 2, 16, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30, and 31 records; the August 1 Parts 1-3, August 3, 4, 5, 6, 10 Parts 1-2, 11, 12 Parts 1-2, 14, 16, and 24 records; and the September 7, September 8, September 8 Part 2, September 9, September 11, September 12 Part 1, September 12 Part 2, September 15, and September 16 Part 1 records.
- Compared the complete PDF series for title cadence, root-level filename conventions, same-day part suffixes, opening-summary density, source-material language, baseline and goal framing, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation wording, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, and output-artifact closure.
- Checked `pdftinfo` and `pdffonts` against the September 16 Part 1, September 15, and September 12 Part 2 baselines. The accepted output convention remains US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 fonts, an unencrypted document, and Codex author, creator, and producer metadata.

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- Reviewed current git state through git status, git log, git show, git diff, git rev-parse, and git branch tracking. Confirmed main points at 64cb140, matches origin/main, and carries the complete About Dev source refinement documented here.
- Reviewed commit 64cb140 in full, including its 48 additions and 15 deletions in app/aboutdev/page.tsx, 27 additions and 8 deletions in app/globals.css, and snapshot context updates included in the commit.
- Reviewed the live About Dev source and responsive CSS, including the shared MainNavBar, profile bubble, hero copy, methodology timeline data, paragraph renderer, quote band, and narrow breakpoint rules.

Baseline Status Before September 21 Work

- The September 16 Part 1 state had aligned the Alla Vostra navigation with the shared MainNavBar, refined landing-page device interactions and case-study proof grids, centered the narrow Alla Vostra hero device, and reorganized Overview promo screenshots into one responsive row.
- The About Dev route already existed with a Builder Story structure, shared navigation, circular profile bubble, evidence-based timeline, working-style quote band, My Core Beliefs formation, and project/contact continuation.
- The original About Dev hero headline read The throughline is ownership: design taste, engineering depth, and finished software. Its timeline still used biography-like stage labels such as Started with product interfaces, Moved into native mobile delivery, Closed the backend gap, and Turned process into an artifact.
- The How I Got Here section still described itself as a timeline built around proof, not biography filler, while the user wanted the section to communicate a repeatable professional work methodology.
- Timeline descriptions were plain strings rendered through one paragraph element, so the Project Planning step could not express a true second paragraph without extending the data and rendering model.
- About Dev inherited a broad section:not(.hero) padding rule that overrode the page's intended hero spacing. Browser measurements exposed a 156px navbar-to-eyebrow gap on desktop and a 118px gap on mobile before correction.
- The local Next.js development cache needed a clean reset during the iterative copy and spacing pass, while the dev route itself needed to remain available for immediate browser review.

Goals for September 21

- Reframe the About Dev hero around a concise product-creation point of view while preserving the page's existing profile imagery, navigation, proof chips, supporting lede, and visual identity.
- Move the ownership statement into the quote band so the original positioning language remains visible rather than being discarded.
- Rename How I Got Here's central heading to My Work Methodology and turn all four timeline stages into clear working phases: Industry & Product Research, Project Planning, Scaffolding the Workflow, and Learning-As-I-Go.
- Replace generic timeline descriptions with user-directed copy about market differences, technical planning choices, disciplined project records, and learning through ongoing diff review.

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- Support selective bold, underline, and italic emphasis in timeline copy without changing the broader timeline card system.
- Give Project Planning two actual paragraph elements with visible paragraph spacing rather than simulating the break with a line wrap.
- Correct the About Dev hero's navbar-to-content rhythm across desktop and mobile, then tune the final top gap to the user-approved value.
- Match the hero quotation's responsive scale to the final requested relationship with the page's other white section headings.
- Keep the Martin Prahl nametag under the profile bubble and remove the temporary attribution from the hero quotation.
- Clear the local development cache, keep the local route running, verify responsive browser geometry, run TypeScript and production build checks, restore generated route metadata, and document final committed state.

Work Completed - Hero Narrative and Quote Composition

- Replaced the original ownership hero headline with the final italic product-creation quotation: Zillions of people have a brilliant idea. Few know how to funnel it into a world-changing, must-have product.
- Iterated the quotation through the requested wording passes, including the transitions from brilliant ideas to a brilliant idea, from vague pipedream language to a direct funnel metaphor, and from one-of-a-kind to world-changing.
- Removed the Martin Prahl attribution from the hero after briefly testing it on a separate right-aligned row, while restoring and preserving the Martin Prahl nametag beneath the profile bubble.
- Moved The throughline is ownership: design taste, engineering depth, and finished software into the green quote panel and retained italic quotation styling there.
- Tuned the hero heading repeatedly during review, then settled on clamp(48px, 6vw, 78px), exactly one-and-a-half times the clamp(32px, 4vw, 52px) scale used by My Work Methodology and the other white section headers.
- Kept the existing About Dev lede, proof chips, portrait asset, circular photo treatment, and page-specific shared navbar behavior intact around the new headline.

Work Completed - My Work Methodology

- Renamed the timeline's principal heading from A timeline built around proof, not biography filler to My Work Methodology while preserving the green How I Got Here eyebrow.
- Renamed Step 01 to Industry & Product Research and rewrote its paragraph around the distinction between Banking customers and Video Streamers, and between Global users and American users.
- Added deliberate inline emphasis to Step 01: both uses of not are italicized; Industry & Product Research is bold and underlined; practical is underlined; and UI/UX, Front-End, Back-End, Build & Release is italicized and capitalized.

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- Preserved comprehensive and theoretical as regular text after the user removed earlier italics and underline treatments from those words.
- Renamed Step 02 to Project Planning and replaced the earlier native-mobile delivery summary with product-shaping questions covering Cross-platform versus Platform-specific, Web version versus App-only, and UI-focused versus Back-end heavy.
- Added a second Project Planning paragraph stating that the work helps make difficult decisions about the client's unique product.
- Extended timeline rendering so a step can provide a string or an array of paragraph strings. Array entries now render as separate p elements instead of a br-only visual row.
- Added a 1.55em adjacent-paragraph margin under aboutdev-timeline-copy so the second Project Planning paragraph reads as a true paragraph break.
- Renamed Step 03 to Scaffolding the Workflow and replaced its backend-gap description with a workflow explanation covering read-project briefings, organized commits, real-time snapshots, and end-of-day worklogs.
- Bolded read-project, commit changes, snapshots, and worklogs inside Step 03 so the repeatable documentation tools remain scannable.
- Renamed Step 04 to Learning-As-I-Go and replaced the artifact-focused sentence with a statement about studying and analyzing diffs while the project grows so every coding change remains understood in real time.
- Preserved each timeline card's existing evidence label, index numbering, card geometry, responsive grid behavior, and proof column while changing the narrative model inside the cards.

Work Completed - Responsive Spacing and Local Workflow

- Identified that section:not(.hero) carried greater effective specificity than the original .aboutdev-hero rule, causing the About Dev hero to inherit 88px of section padding instead of its intended page-specific top spacing.
- Changed the hero selector to section.aboutdev-hero so the page-specific padding wins without changing section spacing elsewhere in the portfolio.
- Removed 68px of desktop hero-grid top padding, the 42px restacked override, and the 30px narrow override, preventing multiple layers of vertical offset from accumulating below the navbar.
- Measured the original navbar-to-green About Dev eyebrow gap at 156px on a 1440px desktop viewport and 118px on a 390px mobile viewport.
- First normalized the rendered gap to 24px on both desktop and mobile, matching Alla Vostra's established rhythm and closely tracking the landing page's 16px gap.
- Increased the final user-approved navbar-to-eyebrow gap by 100 percent, producing a verified 48px gap on both 1440px desktop and 390px mobile viewports.
- Cleared the .next development cache after stopping the active dev process. Because direct recursive deletion was restricted by the execution environment, moved the cache into a dedicated temporary directory and restarted Next.js from a clean local cache.

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- Restarted the local Next.js 16.2.10 Turbopack server at `http://127.0.0.1:3000` and confirmed `/aboutdev` returned HTTP 200 after the clean rebuild.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed repeatedly throughout the copy, JSX emphasis, paragraph-rendering, and responsive CSS edits with `tsc --noEmit`.
- npm run build passed during this documentation pass with Next.js 16.2.10, successful Turbopack compilation, completed TypeScript validation, page-data collection, and seven static app routes generated.
- The production route list included `/`, `/_not-found`, `/aboutdev`, `/articles`, `/projects/alla-vostra`, and `/projects/cinerific`.
- Restored `next-env.d.ts` from the generated production route reference back to import `./next/dev/types/routes.d.ts` after npm run build rewrote it.
- Browser geometry checks with Playwright measured the landing navbar-to-first-content gap at 16px, the Alla Vostra gap at approximately 24-30px, and the pre-fix About Dev gaps at 156px desktop and 118px mobile.
- Follow-up browser checks confirmed the final About Dev navbar-to-eyebrow gap is 48px at both 1440 x 900 and 390 x 844 viewports.
- Confirmed the running local About Dev route returned HTTP 200 after source changes, cache clearing, and production validation.
- Reviewed final git state before PDF generation. main points at 64cb140 and tracks origin/main; `next-env.d.ts` has no remaining diff; the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` is the only pre-PDF tracked documentation delta.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- `app/aboutdev/page.tsx` - replaced and relocated hero/quote copy, renamed the methodology section and all four steps, introduced richly formatted timeline content, added multi-paragraph Project Planning data, updated the timeline renderer, and preserved the profile nametag.
- `app/globals.css` - corrected About Dev hero selector specificity, removed stacked top-padding layers, established the final 48px navbar-to-eyebrow gap, scaled the hero quotation, and added visible spacing between adjacent timeline paragraphs.
- `next-env.d.ts` - temporarily changed by npm run build and restored to the repository's dev route import convention before PDF generation.
- `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` - refreshed through `./read_project.sh` for the September 21 documentation pass and updated with current source, git, and worklog inventory context.
- `portfolio_worklog_september21.pdf` - generated as this new root-level dated Portfolio documentation artifact.

Follow-Up Context

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- The final hero quotation intentionally has no author attribution; Martin Prahl remains identified through the nametag under the profile bubble.
- The ownership statement intentionally lives in the green quote band. Future hero-copy changes should not silently remove that supporting positioning line.
- Hero quotation typography intentionally uses clamp(48px, 6vw, 78px), a 1.5x relationship to the page's clamp(32px, 4vw, 52px) white section-header scale.
- The final navbar-to-green-eyebrow gap is intentionally 48px on desktop and mobile after the user requested a 100 percent increase from the normalized 24px gap.
- Project Planning intentionally uses an array of strings so it renders two semantic paragraphs. Keep aboutdev-timeline-copy on the content wrapper and preserve the adjacent-paragraph spacing if that copy evolves.
- Step 01 emphasis is content-specific and intentional: not is italicized, Industry & Product Research is bold and underlined, practical is underlined, and the implementation-discipline list is italicized.
- Step 03's bold read-project, commit changes, snapshots, and worklogs terms are intentional anchors for the Portfolio's documented operating method.
- The local server remains available at http://127.0.0.1:3000. The project remains local-first; no Hostinger sync, deploy-branch update, or public deployment should occur unless explicitly requested.
- The current source is committed at 64cb140 and matches origin/main. This PDF and the refreshed snapshot are documentation artifacts created after that source commit.

Output Artifact

- Created /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_september21.pdf.
- Used the established filename because this is the first Portfolio worklog for September 21, 2026; no Part suffix was needed.
- Produced a US Letter, PDF 1.4, unencrypted document using Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold with Codex title, subject, author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Preserved the established dense technical narrative, section ordering, repeated page footer, and end-of-document continuity notes used by the recent Portfolio worklog series.
- No commit, push, deploy, Hostinger synchronization, or production publish was performed as part of generating this PDF artifact.